

The Money Talk Script Kit

Four sentences for the conversation you've been dreading. The scary part is not the document — it's twelve seconds. Here's how to spend them well.

The frame: you are *not* saying "in case we divorce." You are saying **"I want to do this right."** Two people who survived weddings, leases, and family group chats decide to start married life with zero ambiguity about money.

Timing rules (non-negotiable)

- ✓ **3–6 months before the wedding** — calm, unhurried, never an ultimatum.
- ✗ **Never during a fight.** "We should get a prenup" after a money argument is a grenade.
- ✗ **Never the final week.** Last-minute signing smells like duress — the second-leading reason prenups get tossed.
- ✓ **A boring Sunday morning** — no audience, no clock, no witnesses.

The four scripts

SCRIPT 1 · THE UNIVERSAL OPENER

"I've been thinking about how to do this marriage right, and I read that couples who agree on money before the wedding fight about it less after. Can we look at something together this week? Not a contract — a tool. If we don't like it, we don't use it."

What's missing: the word *divorce*, the word *protect myself*, and any document you already prepared.

SCRIPT 2 · IF YOU EARN MORE (OR HAVE MORE SAVED)

"I want to build this life with you, and I also don't want a shadow over anything. It wouldn't feel right to have assets you didn't see or terms you didn't shape. So let's do this together — we both answer the same questions, and nothing goes in that we didn't both pick."

"We both answer the same questions" is doing the heavy lifting — it kills the one-sided feeling before it starts.

SCRIPT 3 · IF THEY HAVE DEBT, A BUSINESS, OR KIDS FROM BEFORE

"This isn't about doubting you — it's about making sure nothing from before us follows either of us by accident. Your student loans stay yours. Your business stays your business. My kids' situation stays clear. I'd rather us decide that now, calmly, than have a judge guess someday."

You're protecting *them* first. Point at the silent unfairness, not at them — that's the whole trick.

SCRIPT 4 · WHEN THEY ASK: "DO YOU THINK WE'LL FAIL?"

"No. I think we'll succeed, and I want us to succeed with nothing hanging over us. Every couple I know who went through a bad divorce said the same thing: 'We never talked about it when we still liked each other.' I want to talk about it now — while we still like each other."

Warm, honest, and impossible to hear as an insult.

If it still goes badly

Reaction 1 — Hurt. Don't spiral. *"I get why that landed badly. Can I show you what I actually mean tomorrow?"* — then let a neutral tool explain it. Sometimes the messenger is the problem.

Reaction 2 — Silence. People stall when they feel ambushed. Give it two days, then try the shared-tool frame: *"Can we just answer a few questions together and see?"*

Reaction 3 — Flat refusal to ever discuss it. The only alarming response. A marriage is forty years of money conversations, and this is the easiest one you'll ever have. If the easiest one is forbidden, bring in a counselor or mediator before the wedding — not after.

The cheat code: you don't have to be the person holding the contract. Online prenup platforms exist so the awkward questions come from **a screen instead of you** — "What should happen to the house?" Both of you answer, both of you see the other's answer, the document assembles from your shared choices. You stop being the partner who "wanted a prenup" and become the partner who **figured out an easier way**.